

Cuiying Feng, PhD, MBA, AI-Native UX & Market Research Strategist

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SUMMARY <https://grace-cambridge.github.io> | <https://www.youtube.com/@gracephd5>

PhD/MBA researcher with 9 years in academia and 3 years in UX/Market research | AI-scaled research specialist | Learning strategist | DBT Psychology-trained | Avid cyclist & fitness enthusiast

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI & Research Tools: Prompt engineering, Qualtrics, SPSS, Tableau, Sawtooth, Mixpanel, Condens

Statistical Analysis: Regression modeling (linear, logistic, multiple), ANOVA, Hypothesis testing (t-tests, chi-square), Statistical power analysis, Predictive analytics

Methods: Usability testing, A/B testing, MaxDiff, Conjoint, Mixed methods, Survey, User interviews

Programming: Python, R Studio, SQL, Data visualization | **Language:** Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance UX/Market Researcher | Sunnyvale, CA | 2024–Present

- Boosted Session Timer conversion by merging AI-driven churn comment analysis (242 responses) with R Studio insights from Mixpanel data (3,500 paid users) to uncover top paid features and inform family package and student discount strategy.
- Leveraged Prompt Engineering to optimize pricing tiers (Conjoint) and to prioritize features (MaxDiff) for a pre-launch hybrid marketplace startup.
- Enhanced retention by usability testing and Mixpanel analysis for a post-launch social media app.

UX and Product Strategy Consultant, Redgate | Cambridge, UK | Mar 2023–June 2023

- Transformed the monetization roadmap for a newly acquired DevOps SaaS platform.

AI Product Researcher, Subscale | Cambridge, UK | Sep. 2022–Dec. 2022

- Defined pricing and positioning strategy for an AI/ML SaaS product by spearheading market analysis, which informed Go-to-Market decisions and the scalability roadmap.

PhD Researcher/ Post-Doctoral Fellow, Iowa State University | Ames, USA | 2016–2022

- Assessed investment impact on donation growth by conducting a 10-year longitudinal case study by comparing Chinese and U.S. university foundations via DuPont financial analysis; Identified donations predictors by regressing large-scale cross-sectional data from 42 Chinese universities.
- Informed social justice policy and resource allocation by designing a large-scale Qualtrics survey with 1,710 responses from 4,008 students and performing statistical analysis (t-tests, ANOVA).
- Established strategic partnerships between ISU and seven Chinese universities, nearly tripling international collaborations; Delivered presentations to 1,000+ students across 10+ conferences (lead organizer and originator of the International Exchange Program, Bald Eagle & Panda).

Graduate Teaching Instructor (Digital Technology), Iowa State University | USA | 2016–2021

- Delivered cutting-edge technology curriculum (VR/AR, 3D printing) to 180+ undergraduates.

EDUCATION

AI & Computer Science (Course: Python, Machine Learning, Linux) | De Anza Colleges, CA | 2024

MBA (Thesis: LLM Chatbots) (Focus: Venture Capital) | University of Cambridge, UK | 2022–2023

PhD, Higher Ed Leadership (Focus: Learning sciences) | Iowa State University, USA | 2016–2021

BA, International Business and Digital Commerce, English | Zhengzhou Uni., China | 2005–2009

Leadership & Community: Cambridge Alumni Board Treasurer & MBA Group Leader—Managing finances for 2,500 alumni and automating event planning and engagement workflows since 2023.